PARENT TEACHER ORGANIZATION

Dear A. Fantis Families,

March brings plenty of opportunities to celebrate learning and fun. Our lower-grade students are busy this month, showcasing their creativity and curiosity at the Science Fair and celebrating their pride in Greek heritage through songs, dances, and performances in the Greek Independence Day Show. Plus, we'll add a little extra green and festive spirit with our St. Patrick's Day celebrations at school.

With such a full and joyful month ahead, we would love to see as many families as possible at these events. Your presence means so much to our students and helps make these moments even more special. If you're able to lend a hand, we always welcome volunteers, whether it's helping at an event, supporting preparations, or cheering on our students.

Thank you for being such an important part of our school community. We look forward to celebrating, learning, and welcoming spring together!

Warmly,

Your PTO Board

🗓️ Save the Dates 🗓️

- ☐ **Sun, Mar 15 - Wed, Mar 18:** PTO Best Seats Auction for PK-G2 Greek Independence Day Show
- ☐ **Tue, Mar 17:** St. Patrick's Day; Green Dress Down Fundraiser
- ☐ **Thu, Mar 19:** PK-2 Greek Independence Day Show
- ☐ **Thu, Mar 19:** Dr. Kathy Economos' Talk: Dispelling 10 Myths About Women's Health, Church Hall, 7pm
- ☐ **Fri, Mar 27:** PTO Meeting, 8am at the gym
- ☐ **Fri, Mar 27:** K-2 Science Fair, 8:30am
- ☐ **Wed, Apr 1:** Spring Uniform
- ☐ **Thu, Apr 2:** Early Dismissal: Parent-Teacher Conferences; No BtB or clubs
- ☐ **Mon, Apr 6 - Mon, Apr 13:** Easter Recess, No School; Break Camp available

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Step Up to the Plate: Fantis Night at the Cyclones

Our **A. Fantis Night at the Brooklyn Cyclones on Friday, May 29** is shaping up to be a fantastic evening at the ballpark, and we're very close to unlocking a special scoreboard shoutout for our school!

If our group sells 50 tickets, the Cyclones will f**eature A. Fantis on the stadium scoreboard** during the game, giving our community a fun moment in the spotlight. We're already getting close, so every ticket helps us get there!

Tickets are $25 each and include a Cyclones hat and $5 food or merchandise credit. The deadline to order the first batch of tickets is Monday, March 16.

Order Your Cyclones Tickets Here

Fantis Gala Comes to Industry City

We are thrilled to announce that this year's A. Fantis Gala on **Saturday, May 2** will be held at the **Fort Hamilton Distillery** in Industry City. This distinctive Brooklyn venue will set the stage for a memorable evening of community, celebration, and support for our school, perfect for our Kentucky Derby theme. Planning is well underway and, while we've begun securing some fantastic auction items, we need your help to make this event truly spectacular.

We are actively collecting items that will make it exciting and irresistible for bidders. **If you have connections to local businesses or favorite spots around the city**, consider reaching out to see if they would be willing to contribute. Popular auction items often include

restaurant gift cards, classes, museum memberships, camp credits, beauty or wellness services, tickets, unique experiences, or specialty products. In other words, if it's fun, useful, delicious, or uniquely New York, it's probably a great auction item!

In addition, **event sponsorships are available**, beginning with small alumni contributions and extending to larger sponsorship opportunities that include gala tickets and recognition during the event and on our auction platform. Sponsorships play an important role in helping fund the event so that ticket prices remain low. All gala proceeds benefit the Facilities Fund.

Auction Item Donation Form

Gala Sponsorship Information & Donation Letter

Thank you for helping create a wonderful evening for Fantis. If you have questions or ideas, we'd love to hear from you! Find us at drop-off/pick-up, or reach out at pto@afantis.org.

BYOC to School for the Next PTO Meeting

We're looking forward to seeing you all at our next **in-person PTO meeting on Friday, March 27, at 8am.** We'll be gathering at the school just before the K-2 Science Fair, making it an easy time to stop by and stay informed about what's happening around the school and our upcoming initiatives. Whether you are a PTO regular or a first-timer looking to see what we're all about, we would love to have you there. It's BYOC — Bring Your Own Coffee!

Used Uniform Sale
Before and after the meeting, we'll also be hosting a **Uniform Sale**, which is always a hit with families, especially when we're preparing to switch to Spring uniform on April 1st. So get a head start on your spring cleaning and bring any gently used items (no holes, no stains) that don't fit your kid(s) to the meeting, and we'll add them to the sale for other families to enjoy.

A Heartfelt Thank You to the Ladies Philoptochos

The Ladies Philoptochos of St. Constantine and Helen Cathedral have generously donated $1,000 to the A. Fantis PTO in support of our school community! Their gift was part of Operation Classroom, a National Philoptochos initiative run through the DonorsChoose platform, reflecting their ongoing commitment to faith, education, and philanthropy. We are working with the school to determine where the funds will be most needed. We are deeply grateful to the Ladies Philoptochos for their generosity and partnership.

Support Fantis with RaiseRight

With **RaiseRight**, every gift card you buy — whether it's for morning coffee, weekly groceries, or last-minute items — earns money for A. Fantis. It's the easiest way to support our teachers and students without additional cost.

There are 750+ participating brands, including Target, Sephora, American Express, and Hilton. View the full brand list here!

Setting it up takes just a minute:
1) Visit **RaiseRight.com/Enroll**
2) Enter the code **6KPJTVYVYN9X** to link to **A. Fantis**
3) Download the app and start shopping!

Tip: Use RaiseRight gift cards when buying items from teachers' wish lists or classroom economy supplies - you'll give back twice in one purchase!

More Ways to Shop, Save & Support Fantis

Did you know you can **save money AND support A. Fantis at the same time**? Our yearlong fundraisers make it easy: shop for exclusive discounts, and a portion of every purchase goes right back to our school programs.

- **1st Place Spirit Gear:** Show off your school pride. Our 1st Place Spirit Gear is now always available, and every order helps fund PTO initiatives. NEW: Get **20-30% off** sitewide during their Spring Spirit Wear Sale (until Mar 31). No code needed. Plus,

you save $15 on a $75 order and $25 on a $100 order with code SPIRIT308.

- **Mabel's Labels:** Durable name labels for gear and clothes. Search our school at www.mabelslabels.com and save on replacing lost items. 20% of all purchases support the PTO. NEW: During Week 2 of their Birthday Sale, **all clothing labels are 40% off**. You have until this Sat, Mar 14, to purchase.

- **Minted:** Get 20% off cards, gifts & more with code FUNDRAISEAFANTIS while Fantis earns 10% back! Go to www.minted.com .

- **Squadlocker:** Show off your school pride. Our Squadlocker Spirit gear is always available, and every order helps fund PTO initiatives.

- **Shoott:** Use our special link to book your photo session, and a portion of the proceeds will come back to A. Fantis.

- **Box Top$:** Buy the brands you already love and earn $5 for A. Fantis. Learn how to earn using this link and browse all participating brands here.

In Case You Missed It

Here are some of the PTO initiatives from the past month!To be in the know, keep an eye on our emails, Bloomz posts (including albums), and the **PTO Corner** in the *This Week at Fantis* weekly newsletter for the latest updates and opportunities to get involved. You can lend a hand at events or share your ideas and talents. Stay up to date through the School Calendar and the PTO Linktree, and reach us anytime at pto@afantis.org .

Ladies Philoptochos Luncheon - Last Sunday (3/8), the PTO attended the traditional Ladies Philoptochos Luncheon, a beloved community event. You ladies know how to make

an afternoon equally delicious and fun! Pictured from left: Philoptochos President Michelle Tampakis and our PTO co-presidents, Maria Lopez and Val Dixon.

PTO G3-5 Bouldering Event - Last Friday (3/6), our 3rd, 4th, and 5th graders challenged themselves during an exciting evening of bouldering. It was inspiring to see the kids push past their fears, encourage one another, and cheer their friends on every step of the way.

Sneaker Drive - Thanks to our incredible community for embracing our Sneaker Drive initiative and donating dozens of pairs! All sneakers were donated to The Service Collective.

PTO G6-8 Laser Tag Event - On 2/27, our middle schoolers had a blast at Area 53, enjoying an evening of laser tag, arcade games, and plenty of friendly competition. It was a great chance for students to unwind, connect with friends, and make some fun Fantis memories together.